

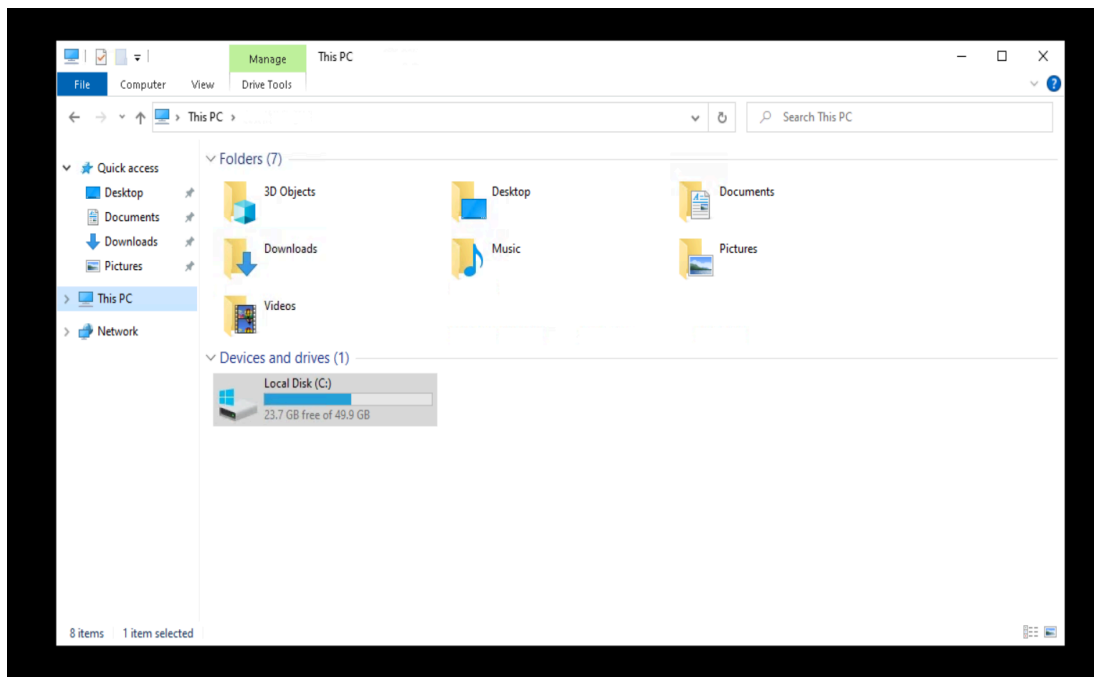
Objective #1

Partitioning and Formatting Drives

In this lab, I worked with a newly added disk in Windows that was initially uninitialized and inaccessible. My goal was to bring the disk online, initialize it using GPT, create a new volume, format it with NTFS, and assign it a drive letter so that Windows could use the new storage.

Review the Current Configuration

1. I clicked the Open environment button to access the Windows Desktop.
I waited about one to three minutes for the environment to become available.
2. I waited another two to five minutes for the SampleFiles folder to appear on the Desktop, which indicated that the setup was complete.

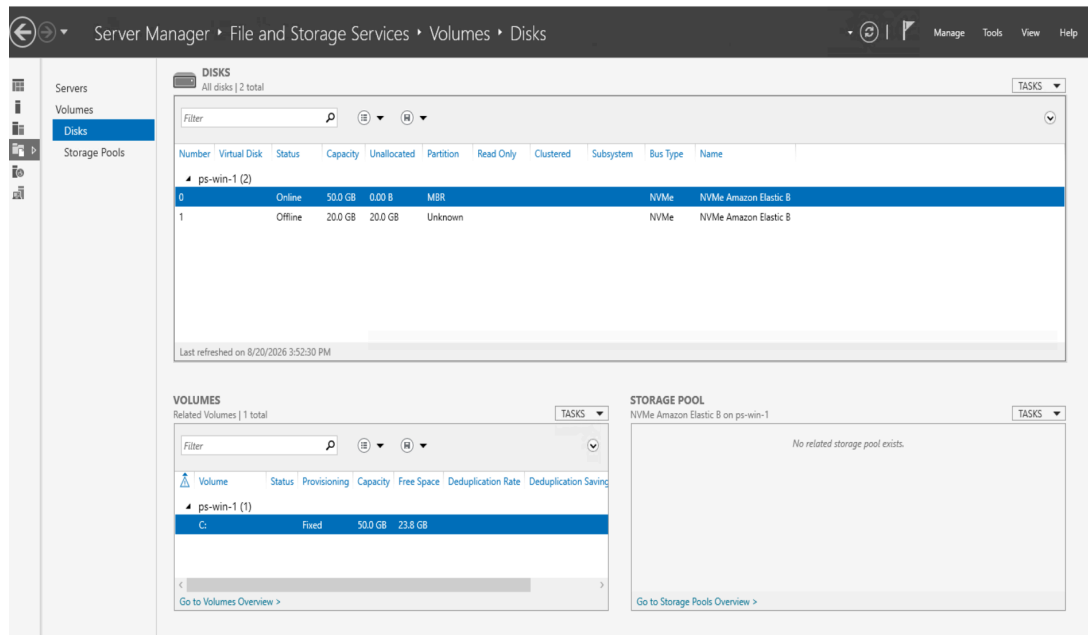


3. Once the setup was complete, I opened File Explorer from the taskbar and clicked This PC.
Under Devices and drives, I observed that the only available drive was the C: drive, which was the operating system drive.
4. I minimized File Explorer to the taskbar because I would need to access it again later in the lab.

Bring the New Disk Online

Before I could use the new disk, I needed to bring it online so Windows could recognize and interact with it. I used Server Manager to manage the disk.

1. I clicked Start on the taskbar and opened Server Manager.
A Try Windows Admin Center pop-up appeared, so I closed it.
2. In Server Manager, I selected File and Storage Services from the left-hand panel and then clicked Disks.
I waited several seconds for File and Storage Services to appear in the menu.
3. In the Disks panel, I noticed that Disk 1 had an Offline status.



I right-clicked Disk 1 and selected Bring Online.

Note: Bringing the disk online allowed Windows to interact with the disk hardware.

4. When the Bring Disk Online prompt appeared, I clicked Yes to confirm that I wanted to bring the disk online.

Initialize the Disk

After bringing the disk online, I needed to initialize it so Windows could prepare it for storing data. I used the GUID Partition Table (GPT) partitioning standard.

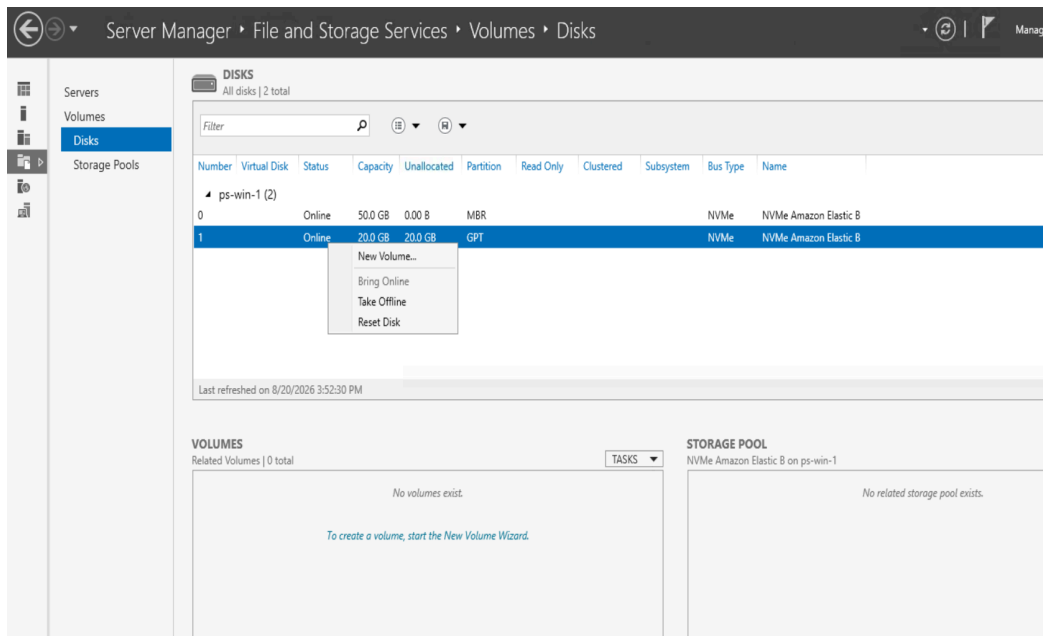
1. I right-clicked Disk 1 again and selected Initialize.
2. When prompted to confirm the initialization, I clicked Yes.
The prompt indicated that any existing data on the disk would be erased.

Create a New Volume

After initializing the disk, I created a new volume so that Windows could use the available storage. I partitioned the disk, formatted the volume using NTFS, and assigned it a drive letter.

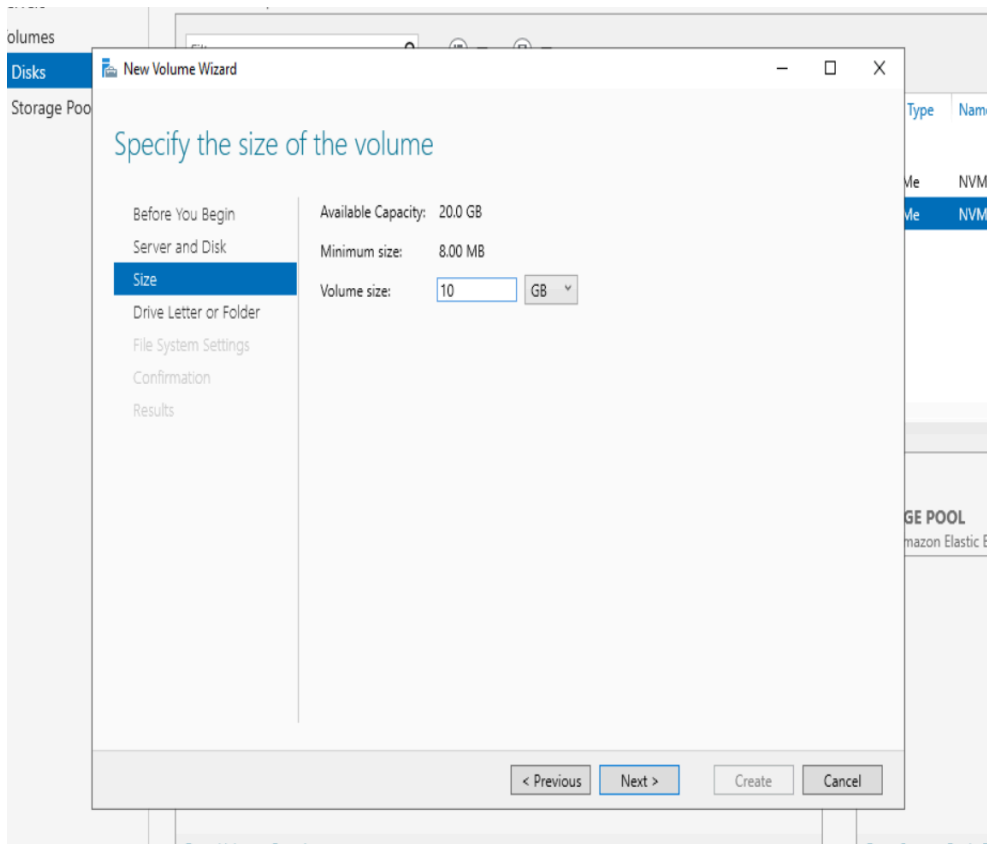
1. I right-clicked Disk 1 and selected New Volume... to open the New Volume Wizard.

2. On the Before you begin screen, I clicked Next.



3. On the Select the server and disk page, I clicked Next.
The wizard automatically selected the correct server and disk because I launched the wizard directly from the target disk.
4. I entered 10 GB as the volume size and clicked Next.
I created a 10 GB volume so that part of the available disk space would remain available

for exploring other options later, such as expanding the volume.



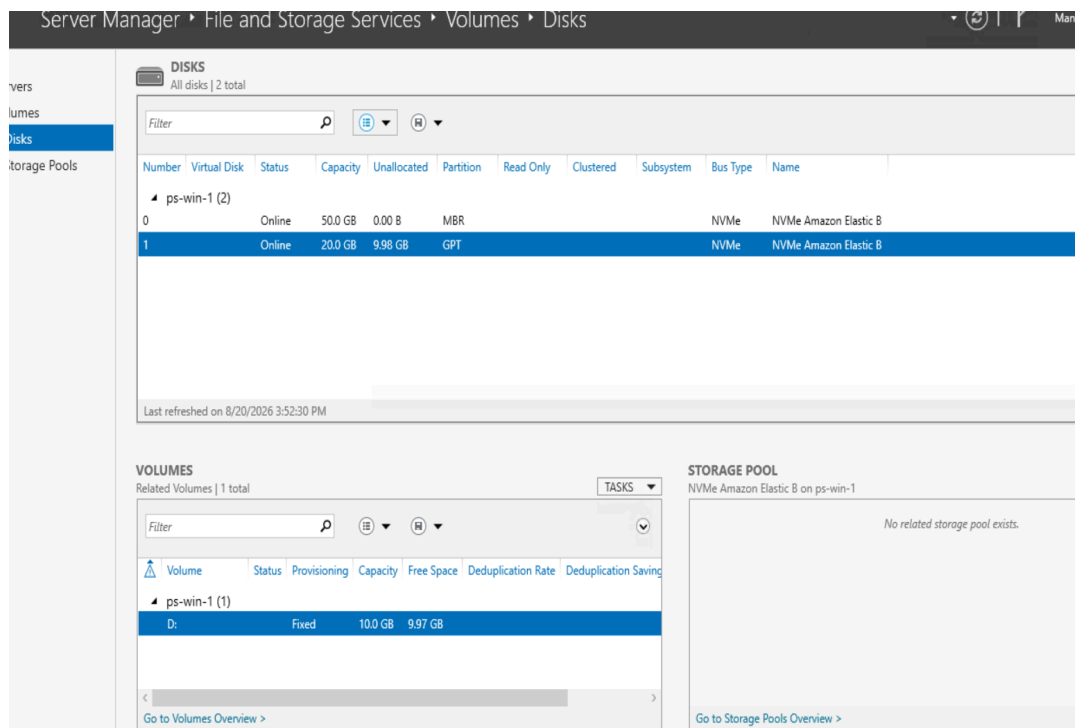
5. On the Assign to a drive letter or folder screen, I left the default Drive letter option selected and selected D from the available drive letters. I then clicked Next.

Analysis: I also reviewed the other mounting options:

- Mount in a folder: This would allow me to mount the volume inside an existing folder instead of assigning it a separate drive letter.
 - Do not assign a drive letter or folder: This would leave the volume without a normal File Explorer drive letter, which could be useful for certain applications or backup solutions.
6. I left NTFS selected as the File system and Default selected for the Allocation unit size. I entered File Storage as the Volume label and clicked Next.
 7. On the Confirm selections screen, I reviewed my configuration and clicked Create.
 8. After the volume was successfully created, I closed the New Volume Wizard.
 9. In Server Manager, I clicked Disk 1.

I verified that the new volume appeared in the volumes pane as a 10.0 GB volume

mounted as the D: drive.

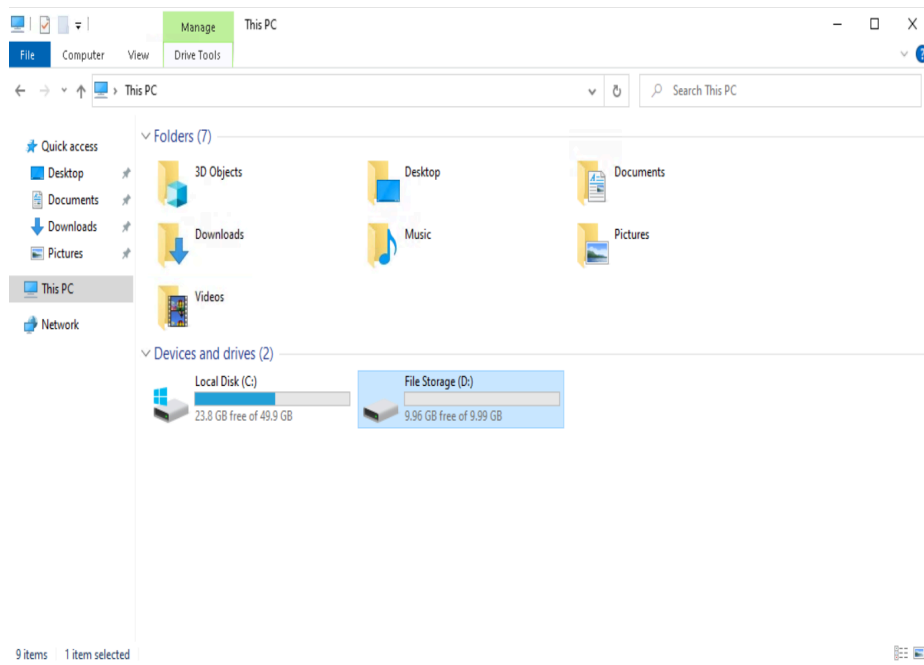


Verify the New Drive

1. I clicked the folder icon on the taskbar to restore File Explorer.
2. In This PC, I checked Devices and drives and confirmed that the new D: drive was available.

The drive was labeled File Storage, confirming that the new volume had been

successfully created and mounted.



The disk was now online, initialized, partitioned, formatted with NTFS, and accessible through Windows as the D: drive. It was ready to be used for storing data.